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Indian crypto exchange
CoinDCX confirms \$44M
stolen during hack

India's largest crypto exchange [CoinDCX](#) has confirmed that one of its internal operational accounts was compromised in a recent security breach, allowing the hackers to make off with millions in crypto.

On Saturday, CoinDCX co-founder and CEO Sumit Gupta disclosed [in a post on X](#) that an internal account "used only for liquidity provisioning on a partner exchange" was compromised during the hack. The executive assured that the incident did not affect customer funds and that all its customer assets remain secure.

Earlier in the day, crypto security researcher ZachXBT reported that around \$44.2 million was drained from CoinDCX's coffers due to the incident.

"The attacker address was funded with 1ETH [Ethereum] Tornado Cash and later bridged a portion of the stolen funds from Solana to Ethereum," the researcher posted on their Telegram channel.

CoinDCX confirmed the loss amount to TechCrunch, stating that the funds were routed through Solana-Ethereum bridges and consolidated into 4,443 Ethereum and 155,830 Solana, which currently remain dormant. The crypto exchange also noted that it is working with India's Computer Emergency Response Team, CERT-In, and partner exchanges to investigate the matter.

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The Indian crypto exchange, registered with the government's Financial Intelligence Unit, boasts over 16 million users and offers access to more than 500 crypto assets.

"The incident was quickly contained by isolating the affected operational account," said Gupta in an X post. "Since our operational accounts are segregated from customer wallets, the exposure is only limited to this specific account and is being fully absorbed by us — from our own treasury reserves."

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Gupta noted that the company was working with the exchange partner to block and recover assets. "I understand incidents like this can be unsettling — even when customer assets are unaffected," he said.

The exchange also [launched a "recovery bounty" program](#) on Monday to award up to 25% of any recovered funds to anyone who can help trace and retrieve the stolen crypto.

“More than recovering the stolen funds, what is important for us is to identify and catch the attackers, because such things shouldn’t happen again, not with us, not with anyone in the industry,” said Gupta.

News of the breach comes [almost exactly a year since the massive breach at Indian crypto exchange giant WazirX](#), which resulted in the loss of \$230 million — nearly half its reserves. The exchange halted trading after the loss. It remains unclear, however, whether there are any connections between the two incidents.

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SECURITY





Hackers steal \$112 million of XRP Ripple cryptocurrency

Lorenzo Franceschi-Bicchierai, Jacquelyn Melinek

8:14 AM PST · January 31, 2024

On Tuesday, hackers stole around \$112 million of the Ripple-focused cryptocurrency XRP from a crypto wallet, Ripple's co-founder and executive chairman has disclosed.

Ripple's Chris Larsen said on Wednesday that the stolen crypto was his. Larsen [wrote on X](#) (previously Twitter) that "there was unauthorized access to a few of my personal XRP accounts (not Ripple) — we were quickly able to catch the problem and notify exchanges to freeze the affected addresses. Law enforcement is already involved."

Larsen wrote the post less than an hour after the well-known crypto security researcher ZachXBT broke news of the hack.

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laundered through several crypto exchanges and platforms, including Binance and Kraken. Binance spokesperson Simon Matthews told TechCrunch that the company is “aware and actively supporting the investigation.”

“We are aware of the incident. We have an incident response capability and undertake proactive review of open source to identify incidents such as this, engage with victims and prevent Kraken from being used in this way,” Kraken spokesperson Megan Thorpe told TechCrunch in an email.

However, the details of who controls and owns the hacked wallet is murky, as it may — or may not be — Ripple’s wallet.

According to on-chain [data](#) from XRPScan, the hacked wallet was called “Ripple (50)” and was activated by a separate wallet called “~FundingWallet1” on November 5, 2018. The ~FundingWallet1 was [activated](#) by Larsen’s account on February 6, 2013, about a month after his [own account](#), ~chrislarsen, was created.



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When TechCrunch reached out to Ripple, the company’s spokesperson Stacey Ngo referred to Larsen’s post and said that “Ripple was not impacted.”

Ripple has been around since 2012 and aims to be a [payments and enterprise infrastructure provider](#) made up of a network, protocol and decentralized public ledger called XRP Ledger. The network’s token, XRP, has a market capitalization of \$27.4 billion and has fallen about 4% on the day following the news of the hack, according to CoinMarketCap [data](#).

Now, some XRP holders are calling for the co-founders to disclose their crypto wallets and XRP holdings in an effort to improve transparency, while others like Thinking Crypto podcast host Tony Edward are [calling for](#) Larsen to “distance himself from Ripple as much as possible.”

This hack is the largest theft of cryptocurrency in 2024 so far, and the twentieth largest theft of cryptocurrency in recorded history, [based on data collected by Rekt](#), a website that tracks web3 and crypto breaches.

Last year, [hackers stole around \\$2 billion in cryptocurrency](#), according to crypto security firms that track these types of hacks.

This story was updated to include a statement from Kraken’s spokesperson.



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Jacquelyn Melinek was a reporter at TechCrunch covering cryptocurrency.

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North Korean Lazarus hackers linked to \$100M Harmony bridge theft

Researchers have linked Lazarus Group, a notorious North Korean state-backed hacking group, to the theft of \$100 million in crypto assets from Harmony's Horizon Bridge.

Last week, [U.S. crypto startup Harmony warned of a "malicious attack" on its Horizon Bridge](#), a cross-chain bridge that allows users to transfer their crypto assets from [one blockchain to another](#). The attacker stole \$100 million in crypto assets, including Ethereum (ETH), Binance Coin, Tether, USD Coin and Dai.

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London-based blockchain analysis provider Elliptic, [which has published an analysis of the attack](#), writes that the hackers converted the stolen assets to 85,837 ETH through Tornado Cash, a mixer [commonly used](#) to launder illegally obtained crypto. So far, the attacker has sent 35,000 ETH — worth \$39 million, or about 41% of the total funds stolen — to Tornado Cash.

Chainalysis, another blockchain security firm that's working with Harmony to investigate the hack, [backed](#) up Elliptic's findings.

Elliptic linked the attack to Lazarus Group, saying the "hack and the subsequent laundering of the stolen crypto assets" is consistent with the activities of the North Korean hackers. It notes that while no single factor proves the involvement of Lazarus in the Horizon Bridge attack, the group has

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“perpetrated several large cryptocurrency thefts totaling over \$2 billion, and has recently turned its attention to DeFi [decentralized finance] services such as cross-chain bridges.”

In April, the U.S. Treasury Department [linked](#) the North Korea-backed hacking group to the theft of \$625 million in cryptocurrency from the Ronin Network, an [Ethereum-based sidechain](#) made for the popular play-to-earn game [Axie Infinity](#).

Elliptic notes that the attack was carried out by compromising the cryptographic keys of a multi-signature wallet, a technique commonly used by Lazarus Group, adding that the programming laundering of funds it observed following the Horizon Bridge hack was “very similar” to that seen following the Ronin Bridge attack.

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“Lazarus Group tends to focus on APAC-based targets, perhaps for language reasons,” Elliptic added, referring to the Asia-Pacific region.

“Although Harmony is based in the US, many of the core team have links to the APAC region.”

In [a series of tweets](#) on Thursday, Harmony said that it has begun a “global manhunt” for the criminal(s) responsible for the \$100 million theft. “All exchanges have been notified. Law enforcement, Chainalysis, and AnChainAI have active investigations to identify the responsible actors and recover the stolen assets,” it said. “We are providing one FINAL opportunity for the actor(s) to return stolen assets with anonymity.”

The company also offered the attacker a final ultimatum, pledging to drop its investigation if the funds were returned minus a \$10 million bounty. Harmony is also offering \$10 million for information leading to the safe return of the funds.

[Hacker exploits Harmony blockchain bridge, loots \\$100M in crypto](#)

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